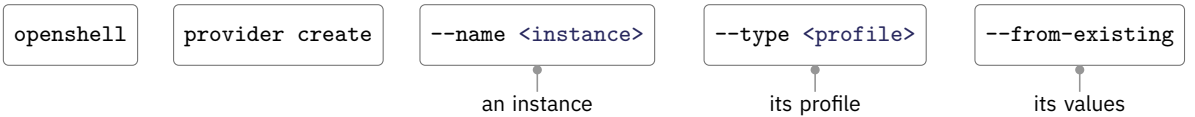the shape of the command